

TECHSANS NOW 2-2

Stumbling Miners To Battle Raiders

(Special To The Avalanche-Journal)

EL PASO — University of Texas-El Paso coach Andy Cohen has declared the next two days "open-arms weekend" but after battling the Red Raiders on consecutive days, the Miner mentor's chuckle of "We hope to win at least one more game this year" may turn into a frightening reality.

Kal Segrist's Techsans brings a 2-2 ledger into the border town while the hometown nine stands but 2-6, having dropped its last four outings in what Cohen calls UTEP's "most enterprising schedule" of its six-year diamond history.

Tech holds a 3-2 series edge over the Miners despite dropping two of three to the hard-hitting El Pasoans last year in Lubbock.

However, since that meeting the Miners have lost their slugging power. For instance, Charlie West, a .366 hitter 12 months ago, is at .188. Danny Blanco is down to .125 from .355. Juan Sandoval has fallen from a .339 perch to .231 and John Murphy, a .327 hitter last time around, is down to .167.

As a team, the Miners have fallen from a .326 overall average compiled during that 25-12-1 season to a .203 this year.

UTEP lost two of three to the University of New Mexico and split with Albuquerque before running into Arizona and the "best college pitching staff assembled in many a year."

In those three games, the Miners scored five runs and al-

lowed Arizona to dent the plate 37 times, losing 8-0, 5-0 and 14-5. In addition, regular first sacker Johnny Miller pulled a hamstring muscle and will miss the Tech series.

The Raiders, however, will have to face Jess Lujan and lefty Lynn Hunt, a duo that compiled a 16-4 mark last season. Lujan is 1-1 this time around and Hunt is 1-2.

Segrist plans to use three hurlers today as the Raiders, hampered by bad weather since the word "go" this year, are searching desperately for three top flight starters to use when conference play rolls around for seven days hence.

Buddy Hampton, Gary Hughes and Pat McKean will see action today with Floyd Lowrey, Gary Washington and Pat Abbott going Saturday. Larry Watts will be ready for bullpen duty.

The Raiders were able to practice only two days this past week, getting in a day's work Tuesday at Lowrey Field and Wednesday at Tech before departing for the Border City at 8 a.m. Thursday.

McKean, the "little" (6-6, 190) freshman who owns both Raider wins, has hurled 15 frames, yielding one run on six hits, walking six and fanning 16. Hughes and York have each lost a game.

Tech's lineup will be shuffled somewhat today as Lonnie Whitfield and John Owens will get in some playing time. Whitfield, one for three in pinch hit roles,

See RAIDERS Page 5

Track Action Starts Today

While most of the South Plains track action doesn't begin until Saturday, several schools will head for Odessa or Panhandle and two-day meets.

The West Texas Relays at Odessa will be without university or college teams for the first time. And to help replace the colleges, officials have expanded the school competition to four divisions.

A smattering of finals are